

Bridge Day 18 STUDENT WORKBOOK

Python Seminar Synthesis: Plan, Trace, Debug, Explain, Support

Learning sequence: Predict - Trace - Explain - Test - Interpret

Guided engineering evidence workbook

Name		UIN		Section	
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Concrete engineering situation

Exam 2 is complete. Day 18 first synthesizes the familiar bridge evidence routines, then introduces functions as the first post-exam Python structure. Plan before code, trace state, test and debug from expected-versus-actual evidence, explain the result, and name a support plan before packaging a bounded rule in a function.

Engineering task	Turn repeated and stored checkout evidence into a complete, explainable evidence routine.
Computational move	Combine loop/list trace, mutation state, debug/test evidence, and explanatory writing.
Python focus	Review first: loops, list state, tests, and explanation. Post-exam handoff: function definitions, parameters, calls, and returned values.
Evidence to keep	problem plan, state ledger, list state after each pass, expected output, actual output, bug cause, minimal fix, protective test, support plan.

Day 18 working rules

1. Complete the synthesis work before the function handoff.
2. Start with a plan and state variables before code.
3. Trace each pass before trusting the final output.
4. Debug with expected, actual, likely cause, minimal fix, and protective test.
5. Treat function definitions, parameters, calls, and returns as the one new post-exam structure today.

Evidence map. Manage your evidence

blueprint

Part	Section	Evidence focus
1	Inventory the evidence routines you already know	synthesis, inventory
2	Plan before code	plan, state
3	Trace state pass by pass	trace, mutation
4	Debug from expected and actual evidence	debug, test
5	Explain the evidence to another student	explain, transfer
6	Support plan for final synthesis	support, reflect

1. Inventory the evidence routines you already know

synthesis

inventory

Circle what you can do independently and name the evidence routine that proves it.

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
2	For/range trace routine: what do you record each pass?	
2	While termination routine: what proves the loop stops?	
2	Break/continue routine: what proves skipped versus stopped work?	
2	List-state routine: what do you write after mutation?	
2	Debug/test routine: what are the five evidence pieces?	

2. Plan before code**plan****state**

Use the integrated Day 18 code as a synthesis case. Before tracing, identify the state.

```
charges = [84, 72, 80, 65]
fix_count = 0
ready_count = 0

for index in range(len(charges)):
    if charges[index] < 80:
        charges[index] = 80
        fix_count = fix_count + 1
    if charges[index] >= 80:
        ready_count = ready_count + 1

print(charges)
print(fix_count)
print(ready_count)
```

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
2	What list state exists before the loop?	
2	What state variables are initialized before the loop?	
2	Why does this job need an index loop?	
2	What should the final list represent?	
2	What should the two counts represent?	

3. Trace state pass by pass

trace

mutation

Complete a state ledger for the loop. Keep old value, condition, action, new list state, and count values visible.

```
charges = [84, 72, 80, 65]
fix_count = 0
ready_count = 0

for index in range(len(charges)):
    if charges[index] < 80:
        charges[index] = 80
        fix_count = fix_count + 1
    if charges[index] >= 80:
        ready_count = ready_count + 1

print(charges)
print(fix_count)
print(ready_count)
```

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
2	Index 0 ledger: old value, action, list state, counts.	
2	Index 1 ledger: old value, action, list state, counts.	
2	Index 2 ledger: old value, action, list state, counts.	
2	Index 3 ledger: old value, action, list state, counts.	
2	Write the final printed values.	

4. Debug from expected and actual evidence**debug****test**

Suppose a student starts the loop at index 1. Use the expected/actual routine rather than guessing.

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
2	Expected final list for the synthesis code.	
2	Actual final list if the loop starts at <code>range(1, len(charges))</code> .	
2	Likely cause of the hidden bug—and why this dataset fails to expose it.	
2	Minimal fix.	
2	Protective first-item and last-item tests.	

Common mistake to avoid

A skipped first item can hide inside a final count if you do not write the list state.

5. Explain the evidence to another student**explain****transfer**

A secure explanation connects code shape to evidence, not just to a final answer.

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
3	Explain why an index loop is appropriate for this code.	
3	Explain why ready_count reaches 4 after mutation.	
2	Explain why fix_count and ready_count answer different questions.	
2	Write one sentence that would help a student who only guessed the final output.	

6. Support plan for final synthesis**support****reflect**

Close Day 18 by making support visible rather than private.

Pts.	Prompt	My evidence / response
4	Name your weakest evidence routine and the exact support move you will use.	
2	Circle your support plan: plan / for trace / while termination / control flow / nested loop / list state / mutation / debug-test / explanation.	
2	Write one commitment for Day 19 support work.	

Support plan

Day 19 is support and transition planning. It should strengthen existing evidence routines rather than introduce new Python content.

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Bridge Day 18 STUDENT WORKBOOK

VIP Evidence Handoff

Learning sequence: Predict - Trace - Explain - Test - Interpret

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Why engineers use this page

After Exam 2, begin with the notebook's input/function/f-string reconnect, then package familiar decisions, loops, list traversal, and arithmetic inside functions and verify returned values with independent cases.

Decision boundary: Code is useful only when its stored state, visible result, assumptions, units, limits, and tests support a defensible engineering interpretation.

Construct readiness before independent work

New authoring tools: function definition, parameter, function call, return statement, returned value

Carried authoring tools: assignment, print call, input call, int conversion, float conversion, f string, arithmetic expression, aggregate builtin call, comparison expression, boolean operator, if elif else, for loop, while loop, list traversal, append call

Supplied-code exposure only: none

An exposure-only construct may be traced in complete supplied code, but the independent task will not require students to invent it before its authoring day.

Notebook cells and task constructs

Activity	Work	Stable cells	Required authoring constructs
18.28	Service Cycle Rule	18-28-work / 18-28-transfer / 18-28-cold	arithmetic expression, boolean operator, function definition, return statement
18.29	Largest Deviation	18-29-work / 18-29-transfer / 18-29-cold	for loop, function definition, return statement
18.30	Valid Batch Sizes	18-30-work / 18-30-transfer / 18-30-cold	arithmetic expression, for loop, function definition, return statement
18.31	Progress Goal Day	18-31-work / 18-31-transfer / 18-31-cold	comparison expression, for loop, function definition, return statement
18.32	Practice Plan Minutes	18-32-work / 18-32-transfer / 18-32-cold	aggregate builtin call, f string, function definition, input call, int conversion, return statement

Readiness evidence

1. Label the header, parameters, body, local state, return statement, call, and returned value in one mapped activity before editing it.
2. Explain why a returned value and printed test evidence are related but not interchangeable, then name one breaking or boundary case.

Timing and help trigger

Record a first prediction before running. If you still lack an executable plan after about 8 focused minutes, use the linked ThinkCSPy refresher or the supplied model. If two attempts fail for the same named requirement, write the exact mismatch and ask a peer mentor or instructor a targeted question. Timing is diagnostic evidence, not a speed grade. **Start or elapsed minutes:** _____ **My help trigger:** _____

Engineering Evidence Record

Complete one record from a model, transfer, or Independent Program Studio build. Generic statements are not sufficient; use actual values, a real revision, and one concrete next test.

Evidence field	Record
Prediction	
Observed Result	
Revision Reason	
Engineering Meaning	
Units Or Not Applicable	
Assumption	
Model Limit	
Next Test	
Help Trigger	
Minutes Used	

Notebook and submission procedure

1. Attempt, predict, run, inspect, and revise before opening a reveal.
2. Complete the end-of-notebook Independent Program Studio without a reveal or copied solution. Only those visibly labeled Studio cells are scored for independent mastery.
3. Save or download the completed notebook as one `.ipynb` file.
4. Upload that one notebook to the matching Gradescope assignment. Do not export a `.py` file or create a ZIP.